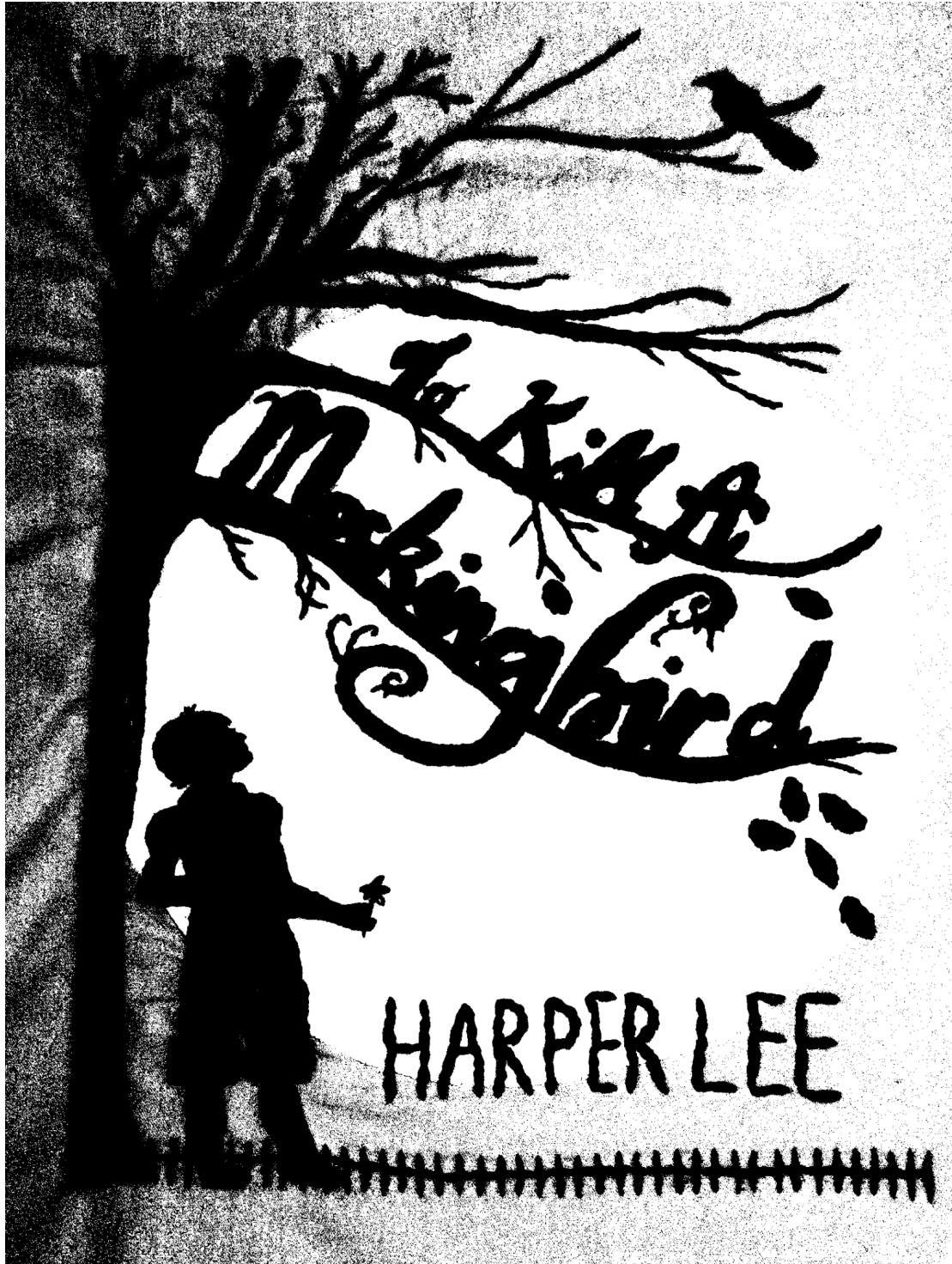


To Kill A Mockingbird



Name: Nicholas Yun

Rationale

My objective of writing the newspaper article on the fire in To Kill A Mockingbird is to show readers that the fire is as significant and impressionable as the trial of Tom Robinson. I intend to elicit the drama and the extent of the damage that was inflicted upon Maycomb. Thus, I plan on extracting key events about the fire and elaborating it more meticulously using descriptive phrases, like “gutted by raging flames”. Simple, elaborate vocabulary is used as the article is meant for the masses. The article is a factual recount; retelling the event in chronological order, using the Inverted Pyramid Concept, to allow readers to have some background information before providing specific details on the event later. Furthermore, quotes and details from the novel will be included throughout the article. These ensure that readers have a sense of familiarity when comparing it with information from the novel.

THE MAYCOMB TRIBUNE

No. 1354

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 22, 1934

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Maudie House On Fire

By NICHOLAS YUN

MAYCOMB – Miss Maudie Atkinson, aged 57, had her house, situated in Central Maycomb, completely gutted by raging flames early yesterday morning at around 1:00 am. The night that had passed shortly before the incident was one of the coldest in memory - a staggering sixteen degrees.

Just a little after one, plumes of thick, suffocating smoke enveloped Maycomb County and orangey tongues of fire devoured Maudie's house. When interviewed on the cause of the fire, Maudie answered, "It was probably the flue in the kitchen. I kept a fire in there for my potted plants."

Everyone was up and about trying to put out the ferocious fire and save as

much furniture as possible. The old fire truck of Maycomb however took ages to arrive, as it had to be pushed through the snow. Shortly after, its water pipe burst, rendering it useless.



Maudie Atkinson's house consumed by the flames.

One of her immediate neighbours, Avery, assisted in saving furniture upstairs. He was the only casualty, slipping on a pillar while trying to escape. "I'm just a tad sore. Must've been those pesky children that started

Eventually, the fire was extinguished with the combined effort of the county and another two fire trucks that arrived subsequently. "I would like to sincerely apologise regarding the breakdown of the Maycomb fire engine. A stocktake will definitely be conducted, to ensure that such occurrences does not happen again," Francis Brooks, head of fire department, stated grimly.

With most of her possessions gone and her beloved yard a shambles, it is amazing how Maudie still takes a lively, cordial interest in others' affairs and maintains a positive outlook. "The only thing I worried about was all the danger and hubbub it caused. This whole neighbourhood could have gone up. Anyway, I've always hated that old cow barn. Always wanted a smaller house, gives me more yard."

In addition to the drama, there were a couple of unanticipated appearances.

all this."

Nathan Radley also participated in helping to remove furniture from the house. When asked questions regarding why he came to help, he replied curtly, "She's a nice lady. Anyone like her should be helped."

Allegedly, Boo Radley was at the scene too. Jean Finch, daughter of Atticus Finch, had been standing in front of the Radley Place together with Jeremy Finch. When they returned home, she realised that a blanket had been draped around her. "All of Maycomb was out that night, in one way or another. Who else could it be but Boo Radley?" said Atticus Finch.

Meanwhile, Maudie will be living temporarily with Stephanie Crawford. Additionally, the Maycomb fire department will be carrying out a safety review to educate Maycomb residents on fire safety.